Your Website, in Plain English

A complete beginner's guide to updating Instinct Groove with Codex

Codex is your website assistant. Describe what visitors should see in ordinary language. Codex finds the right files, makes the change, checks it, saves it to GitHub, and publishes it when the request is ready to go live.

>

You are not expected to know HTML, CSS, divs, flex, components, or stylesheets.

THE SIMPLE MENTAL MODEL

YOUR IDEA – CODEX TRANSLATES – YOU REVIEW – CODEX PUBLISHES – VISITORS SEE IT

THREE PHRASES WORTH REMEMBERING

Show me first

Make and check the change, but do not publish it.

Make it live

Publish the approved change and verify the public page.

Undo that

Return only the relevant change to the earlier working version.

SPEAK ABOUT WHAT YOU CAN SEE

Try: "the top of the home page," "the glowing sign," "the event boxes," or "the phone menu." Codex will translate that into the technical work.

How to ask for a change

Four details turn a rough idea into an accurate result

1. **Where?**
   Name the page or visible area.

2. **What should be different?**
   Describe the result a visitor should notice.

3. **What must be exact?**
   Give the wording, date, link, or attached image.

4. **Preview or publish?**
   Say "show me first" or "make it live."

COPY THIS REQUEST

REUSABLE TEMPLATE

On the [page or visible area], change [what visitors currently see] to [the result you want]. Use [exact wording, link, or attached image]. Keep [anything that must stay the same]. Show me the phone and computer versions. [Do not publish yet / Make it live after the checks pass.]

A STRONG EXAMPLE

YOU SAY

On the home page, change the August 14 event message to "Lineup announcement coming Friday." Keep the date and the existing green-on-black style. Show me how it looks on a phone and computer. Do not publish yet.

When words are hard

Say: "I do not know the right website terms. Ask me one simple question at a time, then tell me what you think I mean." A screenshot is often better than a technical explanation.

Prompts you can copy

Replace the words in brackets and send the message

Change words

On the home page, replace "[old sentence]" with "[new sentence]." Keep everything else the same. Show me first.

Update an event

Update the next event to [date]. The venue is [venue], the lineup is [artists], and the ticket link is [URL]. Use the attached poster. Check every place it appears and make it live after verification.

Adjust the look

The first section feels cramped. Add breathing room around the main heading without making the page much longer. Keep the fonts and colours. Show phone and computer previews.

Replace a photo

Use the attached photo as the main event image. Keep the people centred, do not stretch faces, and make sure it looks clear on phones.

Fix a link

The Tickets button on the next event page should open [exact URL]. Check the same button everywhere it appears. Do not change other links.

Review or undo

Explain what changed in plain English and show me screenshots. Do not publish. / Restore the live website to how it was before today's update, then verify it.

Mood-based requests are welcome

Try: "Make this feel more polished and energetic, but keep the black background, the lit wall, the green accents, and the underground event feel. Give me two small options before editing."

Review without feeling technical

Look at the result, not the code

RECOMMENDED FLOW

ASK – PREVIEW – GIVE FEEDBACK – APPROVE – PUBLISH

BEFORE PUBLISHING, ASK FOR

- A phone screenshot and a computer screenshot.
- A three-bullet summary in plain English.
- Confirmation that important buttons and links work.
- Confirmation that no unrelated parts changed.
- A clear statement: Not published yet.

USEFUL FEEDBACK

- Keep the new wording, but put the photo back.
- Only make the heading smaller on phones.
- Undo just the colour change.
- Give the title more breathing room.
- Show me another option. Do not publish.

APPROVAL PHRASE

This version is approved. Make only these reviewed changes live, then confirm the public website matches the preview.

You stay in control

Every published version has a named save point in GitHub. Codex can compare changes, preserve someone else's work, and restore a previous working version without asking you to manage the technical steps.

What happens behind the scenes

You do not need to perform any of these steps

1

Reads the project guide

Loads the always-on instructions for this site.

2

Translates the request

Finds the right content, layout, or media source.

3

Makes the edit

Changes only what is needed; never the studio's scene.

4

Checks both layouts

Reviews phone and computer versions, links, and images.

5

Creates a save point

Records a clear GitHub version of the change.

6

Safely syncs

Keeps compatible work that somebody else added.

7

Publishes with Pages

Automatic safety checks run, then the release.

8

Checks the public site

Confirms the requested result before saying live.

This specific website

content.js holds the events, artists and photos. app.js builds the pages. styles.css controls appearance. assets/ holds approved media. The lit wall, the opening and the page slides live in the studio's own folders, which Codex never edits. A push to main starts the safety checks and the release. You never need to open these files yourself.

The scene behind your pages

What Codex changes directly, and what goes to the studio

Every page hangs on a lit concrete wall with ivy, lamps and fireflies. On a computer the home page opens in the dark and the INSTINCT sign strikes on, and moving between pages slides along the wall. On a phone the opening is a pre-rendered version of the same scene. This scene is the studio's lighting and animation system.

NAMES YOU CAN USE

- **The opening**
  The first seconds on the home page: black, then the sign lights the room.
- **The lit sign**
  The big glowing INSTINCT letters set into the wall.
- **The wall**
  The mossy concrete behind every page.
- **The lamps**
  The pools of light over headings and photos.
- **The vines**
  The ivy at the edges. One or two grow in fresh on every visit.
- **The fireflies**
  The small floating lights.
- **The glowing button**
  The main button on a page, lit from behind.
- **The page slide**
  On a computer, the sideways move from one page to the next.

Codex changes directly

Words, dates, lineups, links and ticket buttons. Photos and posters. New event and artist pages. Colours, sizes and spacing of the page's own text, boxes and buttons.

Goes to the studio

The opening, the sign, the wall, the light and haze, the vines, the fireflies, the glow behind buttons, the page slide and the phone opening. Codex does not edit these; it writes your request down for the studio.

WHAT CODEX WILL SAY

"That is part of the site's lighting and animation system, which the studio looks after; I can pass your request on to them." Then it carries on with any part of your request that is ordinary content.

Why it works this way

The scene is built from the studio's own source and checked automatically before every release. Keeping it out of everyday edits keeps scrolling smooth, the opening intact and the page slides working. If a release ever breaks the scene, Codex restores the previous version safely.

Safety, publishing, and conflicts

Simple client promises for work that affects the live site

THE PROMISES

- "Show me first" never means publish.
- "Make it live" includes only the task you requested.
- Codex does not overwrite another person's compatible changes or hide a problem with a force push.
- If two versions represent a real content decision, Codex asks one plain-English question.
- A change is not called live until the matching release succeeds and the public page is checked.
- Every published version has history and can be restored with a new safe save point.
- Codex never edits the lighting and animation system; it passes those requests to the studio.

What a conflict sounds like in plain English

"Someone else updated the venue while I was changing the ticket link. Should the newer venue stay?" Codex keeps both versions safe while you answer. You do not need to understand Git conflicts.

Never paste secrets

Do not put passwords, payment credentials, private keys, or login codes into a website request. Confirm public dates, venues, prices, artist names, and ticket URLs before publication.

Permission pop-ups

Codex may pause before GitHub, internet, or protected actions. Approve only when the short reason matches the task you requested. Ask for a plain explanation if it does not.

IF A RELEASE IS STOPPED

The safety check caught a problem, so the new version is not live yet. Codex will keep the previous site available when possible, fix the issue, and verify again before claiming success.

When something goes wrong

Use one of these messages and let Codex investigate

I cannot see the update

Check the latest release and public page. If it is live, help me rule out browser caching.

It looks wrong on my phone

On my [phone/browser], this area looks wrong. Use the screenshot. Fix the phone version without changing the computer version.

The photo crop is bad

Use the original photo. Keep [person/object] visible and centred. Show the phone crop before publishing.

I am too frustrated to explain

I know it feels wrong but cannot name why. Ask one simple visual question at a time and suggest two likely fixes.

TINY GLOSSARY

Codex	ChatGPT that can inspect, change, test, and
Repository	The website project and its saved history
GitHub	The shared online home for the project
Commit	A named save point
Push	Sending a save point to GitHub
Publish	Making a GitHub version public
Preview	Looking before it becomes public
Conflict	Two changes touched the same place
Responsive	Adapts to phones and computers
Studio	The team that looks after the scene

Quick commands

Preview: Show me first. Do not publish.
Publish: Make these approved changes live.
Status: Give me the plain-English status.
Restore: Undo today's live update and verify it.

OFFICIAL OPENAI READING

Getting started
Project guidance with AGENTS.md
Reusable Codex skills
Codex and GitHub